

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager who ships full lifecycle, not just requirements.*

Positioning, a hands-on PM with nearly ten years of end-to-end product delivery across regulated, B2B SaaS environments – ready to drive First Advantage's screening platform forward.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

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§ WHY FIRST ADVANTAGE

Background screening is mission-critical infrastructure: the decisions it enables have real consequences for real people and real companies, which means product quality is not negotiable. First Advantage's scale – 100 million screens annually across 200+ countries – means that even marginal improvements to workflows, data quality, or configurability compound into significant business outcomes. The job description specifically calls out supporting a unified customer experience across the largest platforms, which is exactly the kind of cross-functional, multi-stakeholder challenge I have shipped before (defence, insurance, public analytics). *That is exactly the environment where patient, precise product work creates durable value.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked directly in the HR-tech or background screening industry. The domain-specific compliance details and screening taxonomy will take me two to three weeks to absorb. What I bring immediately is a track record of translating regulated, operationally complex workflows into developer-ready requirements – the same core mechanic, applied to a new domain.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, spec review, edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafts and user story expansion
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo support and acceptance criteria scaffolding
- **Cursor / VSCode**, codebase navigation and spec-to-implementation tracing
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for workflow validation
- **Gamma.app**, product decks and stakeholder presentations
- **n8n**, lightweight automation and agent workflow design
- **Framer**, interactive prototype layouts for UX feedback rounds

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Ionic, JIRA, low-code insurance platforms, CGM API integrations, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & TRADING AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Personal crypto infrastructure project combining a backtest engine with an agent-driven automation layer.

- Builds and tests algorithmic strategies across perpetuals and spot markets using Hyperliquid, Bitget, and Jupiter data.
- Implements a file-queue-based agent loop architecture, separating signal generation, execution logic, and risk management into discrete components.
- Draws on real-world microstructure analysis: liquidation heatmaps, slippage modelling, and routing decisions informed by Coinglass and Hyblock Capital data.
- Demonstrates autonomous feature delivery end-to-end – from problem framing to architecture to working code – exactly the mode of execution this PM role requires.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FIRST ADVANTAGE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the NOAM product workflows end to end: join sprint ceremonies, read existing epics, map the current customer experience across the largest platforms, and identify where requirements break down between business stakeholders and the development team.

WEEK 2

Clarify and slice.

Take the two or three highest-friction backlog items, re-interview the relevant stakeholders, rewrite them as crisp user stories with testable acceptance criteria, and confirm alignment before the next sprint starts.

WEEK 3+

Ship and measure.

Carry the first feature through development, QA, and deployment; instrument it with the right usage metric; bring the result back to stakeholders with a clear view of what the next iteration should address.

I COVER LETTER

Dear First Advantage hiring team,

Product management in a regulated, operationally complex environment is not primarily about generating ideas – it is about translating messy real-world workflows into requirements that a development team can actually execute, and then staying accountable through delivery. That is the work I have been doing for nearly ten years, across a government defence AI programme, a public labour market analytics platform, and a B2B InsurTech SaaS serving primary insurers, reinsurers, and brokers.

The requirement that stood out most in your posting is the mandate to support a unified customer experience across First Advantage's largest platforms. At Emil Group, the InsurTech platform I joined had a 17-person team in delivery paralysis, fragmented sprint discipline, and near-total senior developer attrition. I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt

client trust inside a prototype-stage environment. The result was stable delivery and a single departure instead of a team collapse. The underlying challenge – making a large, multi-module platform feel coherent to its users – is directly relevant to what First Advantage is working toward.

The requirement for strong technical stakeholder management is also one I take seriously. At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned a cross-functional team spanning an architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA, within a multinational European defence programme. I did not just write stories: I unblocked infrastructure-level OpenShift issues independently, reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD, and delivered in one week a feature that the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year. Being technically fluent enough to understand what a team is dealing with – and occasionally to move the blocker yourself – changes the working relationship with engineers in a useful way.

On the Agile methodology requirement: my experience is operational, not certificated. At the Federal Employment Agency, I managed a running analytics platform through major system upgrades, CI/CD standardisation, and new feature delivery while also serving as Deputy IT Security Officer. At CLINET Platforms, I delivered a mobile healthcare app across iOS and Android under tight deadlines, integrating legacy hospital information system APIs that had no documentation. Agile in practice means making the best call with incomplete information, communicating transparently when something will slip, and keeping the team oriented on what matters most – that is the version of it I have been practising.

I am based in Berlin, available within four weeks of an offer, and comfortable with the NOAM time zone coverage the role requires. I would welcome a conversation about how my background maps to First Advantage's current product priorities.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable software systems across regulated B2B environments. Background spans AI data platforms, public analytics infrastructure, InsurTech SaaS, and mobile healthcare applications. Comfortable driving the full product lifecycle from vision and requirements through delivery, adoption, and continuous improvement. Technically fluent across modern software stacks and AI-native tooling, with a track record of unblocking

delivery, rebuilding sprint discipline, and aligning cross-functional stakeholders around a clear product direction.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end lifecycle ownership from charter to post-deployment measurement
 - Translating regulated operational workflows into dev-ready user stories and acceptance criteria
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment across business, engineering, QA, and compliance
 - Sprint discipline recovery and backlog management under delivery pressure
 - Technical fluency sufficient to unblock engineers and navigate infrastructure decisions
 - AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
 - Risk-first product discovery under ambiguity
 - Workshop facilitation with technical and non-technical audiences
 - Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, accountable to outcomes
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA within a multinational European defence programme
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level OpenShift issues independently; delivered in one week a feature requested from engineers for over a year
- Responsible for data transparency and auditability with multinational stakeholders; supported SafeAI and ExplainableAI evaluation concepts

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling across an active public-facing analytics platform
- Designed interactive dashboards, community features, and reporting modules aligned to stakeholder requirements
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades with no service interruption
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Collaborated with regional government stakeholders, data scientists, and engineering teams across distributed locations

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation on a B2B InsurTech platform
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with clear ownership and deputy structures
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport coordination, chat, and document storage across iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, navigating undocumented legacy APIs
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict prioritisation of highest-leverage features
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity and realistic delivery commitments

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption features on a quantum-secure OTP encryption product
- Served as deputy IT security officer; represented the product to enterprise and institutional prospects
- Delivered setup experience requiring under two minutes with no technical knowledge required from end users

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded and built a group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR (various phases)

- Established digital tooling, financial planning, and investor relations for a nanotechnology vertical farming startup across multiple funding phases

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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OPERATING CENTRE

